2016 Ford Fusion SEL

$5,400 · 175,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/27329971493309454/

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder






+ 6 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$6,123	**$506**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 13 recalls · 1,728 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$5,400.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$499.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$35.10
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$6,122.60
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$1,122.60
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$22.49
Total interest over the loan	$227.08
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$22.49
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 26 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$182.69
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.42
Total per month	$505.61

Running costs without the loan: **$483/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$12,148** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Average - IF it has the 2.5L non-turbo. The 1.5L EcoBoost has a coolant-intrusion defect that can ruin the engine. Very high 175k miles and the most recalls/complaints of your shortlist (13 recalls, 1,722 complaints).

NHTSA data for this model year: 13 recalls · 1,728 owner complaints (62 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (465), Power Train (317), Unknown Or Other (226), Steering (184), Electrical System (166), Back Over Prevention (147).

Known issues for this model

• 1.5L EcoBoost: coolant leaks into cylinders (white smoke, coolant loss, misfire)

• 6-speed automatic shudder / harsh shifts

• Electric power steering failure warnings

• Shifter cable bushing can detach -> wrong gear / rollaway (3 recalls)

• Front brake hoses can rupture (recall)

• Door latch, steering wheel bolt, rearview camera recalls

Check on this car before buying

• Confirm engine: 2.5L = OK, 1.5L = walk away

• Check coolant level and exhaust for white smoke

• Shift through P-R-N-D; gear shown must match

• Ford dealer VIN check for open recalls (Jim Charlon Ford)

• Pre-purchase inspection - 175k miles

Notes

$5,400. Automatic, silver/black, gasoline, 4-cyl. 2 owners, paid off. Seller: AC cold, good on gas, 'dependable'. Listed ~17 weeks -> negotiate hard.

Very high miles (175k). No maintenance/smog info - seller must provide smog cert (< 90 days).

ENGINE MATTERS: 2.5L non-turbo = the one you want. 1.5L EcoBoost has known coolant-into-cylinder defect (white smoke, coolant loss, misfire). Ask which engine.

Also check: transmission (6-speed) shudder/harsh shifts; power steering warning lights.

RECALLS (13 for model year; confirm by VIN): shifter cable bushing can detach -> car not in gear shown/may roll away (18V-471, 19V-362, 22V-413) - IMPORTANT; door latch (20V-177, 23V-775 - CA included); front brake hoses may rupture (23V-162); steering wheel bolt may loosen (18V-167); rearview camera (25V-695); plus build-date-specific seat belt/seat/fuel tank.

TODO: get VIN.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.